Sapindus marginatus
Florida Soapberry

Family: Sapindaceae



OTHER



OTHER



OTHER



FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Small tree or large shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Deciduous

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 15–30 ft tall (up to 40+ ft in some reports), spreading form. Small to medium

Sun

Water

Soil
Adaptable; coastal hammocks, calcareous woodlands, shell mound
Well-drained soils

Zone 8a
Native to Georgia; fully adapted to Atlanta Zone 8a. Suitable for coastal or well-drained inland sites. Deciduous with early spring leaf drop. Valuable as a native tree. Fruit/seed toxicity noted — not for edible use. Good for wildlife and naturalized plantings

PLANTING NOTES

Planting
None stated

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to Georgia, Florida, and South Carolina (coastal shell mounds, maritime hammocks). Some taxonomic debate with S. saponaria

Form
Deciduous tree or large shrub. Pale gray or brown ridged/warty bark. Multi-trunked possible

Foliage
Alternate, compound leaves up to 1 ft long with 6–13 lanceolate leaflets (pointed tips, entire margins).
Leaves fall in early spring. Rachis usually unwinged

Flowers and fruit
Tiny pale yellow bell-shaped flowers in clusters (April–June). Oval, golden-brown, leathery, wrinkled fruits (~0.8 in) with large black poisonous seed. Fruit used historically for soap.
Seed and fruit poisonous

Bark
Not stated

HEALTH

Health
Generally low maintenance. No serious pests or diseases highlighted in . Poisonous fruit/seed is the primary caution

Symptoms
None stated